actions IOs take to safeguard their missions? How do these strategies affect perceptions of their legitimacy, fairness, and resilience?

In this concluding chapter, we address these pressing questions. We begin by offering practical recommendations for policymakers seeking to shield IOs from populist pressures. We then explore the broader implications of our findings, considering how IOs can balance the need for self-defense with their commitments to democratic values and multilateral cooperation. Through this lens, we aim to provide a road map for sustaining and strengthening global governance in an era of rising populist sentiment.

9.1 How to Insulate IOs Against Populist Pressure

Our study has highlighted how IOs can defend themselves against populist resistance, but the question remains: How can they proactively fortify themselves against future challenges? Populist parties have assumed power across various regions, and their critiques of global governance show no signs of abating. By anticipating hostility, IOs can not only mitigate damage in a reactionary fashion but also position themselves as resilient pillars of multilateral cooperation. This chapter offers strategies for policymakers and practitioners seeking to reinforce IOs, examining the risks, benefits, and untapped potential of these approaches. We argue that drawing from the full spectrum of strategies we outline—preemptive appeasement and sidelining of leaders and constituents—can provide a powerful toolkit for bolstering IOs against populist threats. These strategies are outlined in table 9.1.

TABLE 9.1. Strategies for insulating IOs against populist pressure

Tactic	Subtactic	Examples
Preemptive sidelining	Diversification and redundancy	Diversify funding sources (e.g., UNICEF partnerships with Unilever, IKEA Foundation); leverage private-sector data and technology (e.g., WTO using private company data); build operational flexibility (e.g., UN peacekeeping funds).